James “Jym” T. Paschall

Senior Site Reliability Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Site Reliability Engineer with deep experience in **Risk & Compliance, security automation, and cloud infrastructure** at scale. Most recently the **Guardrails SME, Terraform SME, and Compliance SME** on Cisco's Duo Security R&C team, where I turned manual security and compliance work into automated systems across **Commercial, Dev, and Federal environments**. **CitVal** validation for U.S. Federal environment access. A quick study who jumps into new domains and tooling fast, eager to bring an automation-first, compliance-aware mindset to teams building the next generation of monitoring and reliability tooling.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Risk & Compliance / Security Automation:** Vulnerability Management & Reporting, Guardrails, Commercial CAP Audit Support, SOC 2, ISO 27001, FedRAMP Moderate (scoping), CIS Benchmarks, Zero Trust Architecture, Service Control Policies (SCPs), IAM, Audit Readiness
- **Site Reliability Engineering:** SLA/SLO/SLI Management, RTO/RPO Compliance, Federal OnCall, Shepherd/ Incident Response, Disaster Recovery, Multi-Environment Operations
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, EKS, IAM, Lambda), Terraform, Terraform Cloud, CloudFormation, Ansible, Teleport (Polaris)
- **Software Engineering:** Python, Java, Bash, HCL, YAML; Microservices, CI/CD, Automation Scripting
- **Observability & Monitoring Tools:** DataDog, CloudWatch, Nagios, OpsView, Splunk, Kibana
- **AI-Augmented Engineering:** Claude Code, LLM prompt engineering, AI-assisted code review and automation
- **Leadership:** Terraform SME, Compliance SME, Technical Mentorship, Cross-Functional Collaboration
- **Working Knowledge:** Kubernetes, Docker, SSO/Active Directory Integration

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cisco | Senior Site Reliability Engineer

Duo Security’s Risk & Compliance Team

July 2025 – July 2026 | Remote

- Slashed unassigned security tickets from **~400/week to less than 5/week** by engineering an AWS Lambda notification microservice — saving an estimated **~20 hrs/week of manual triage per engineer** and reclaiming over **1,000 engineering hours per year**.
- Owned the Guardrails program — the SCPs and CloudFormation templates that enforce security and compliance baselines across Duo's AWS estate. Refactored **10 of 22 core templates**, locked down public access on critical services (AMI, EKS, RDS), and served as the team's go-to resource for Guardrails design and implementation.
- Contributed to **Commercial CAP audit** preparation and **vulnerability management reporting** aligned with **SOC 2 and ISO 27001**; scoped the upcoming **FedRAMP Moderate** audit cycle.
- **Admin** across Duo Security's **Commercial, Dev, and FedRAMP Moderate environments** — full operational authority over resources and employee access provisioning across all three.
- Eliminated recurring manual maintenance by removing legacy tooling across **143 files in 4 environments** (Terraform Cloud, Commercial, Dev, Federal).
- Sustained **99.99% availability** and ensured **RTO/RPO compliance** with company policy by holding multiple FedRAMP Moderate OnCall shifts and responding to live alerts.
- Accelerated team onboarding by serving as shepherd, providing SME-level Terraform support, helping colleagues transition to the **Teleport "Polaris"** access model, and unblocking external teams on SCPs and compliance tagging.
- Integrated Claude Code and LLM workflows into daily engineering, accelerating script maintenance, code review, and infrastructure automation.

Next Tuesday, LLC | Independent Consultant DevOps

June 2025 – July 2025 | Remote

- Delivered custom IaC solutions for enterprise clients using Terraform, Java, and Linux.
- Optimized cloud infrastructure deployments for scalability and security compliance.

Karma Automotive | Senior DevOps Engineer

February 2024 – July 2024 | Irvine, CA

- Decoupled **75,000+ lines of code** by re-architecting AWS Terraform infrastructure into a modular, multi-repository codebase.
- Streamlined automated deployments by **60%** and saved **$3,600/month per AWS account** through resource cleanup.
- Boosted release reliability by **95%** by designing CI/CD pipelines in collaboration with cross-functional teams.
- Built Docker and Kubernetes resiliency roadmap targeting a 50% improvement in system durability.

Airbiquity | Senior DevOps Engineer

March 2020 – February 2024 | Seattle, WA

- Boosted team output by **75%** and reduced manual effort by **30%** through Terraform IaC workflow optimization.
- Centralized **23 AWS accounts** using AWS Organizations, doubling observability and achieving **95%+ CIS Benchmark compliance**.
- Cut deployment times by **50%** by refactoring legacy infrastructure.
- Sustained a **99.99% SLA** managing global & on-prem Linux servers.
- Modernized authentication via SSO + Active Directory integration, reducing management overhead by **80%**.
- Mentored engineers in Terraform best practices and DevOps methodologies.

CLEARANCES & CERTIFICATIONS

- **CitVal (Cisco Citizen Validation)** — Authorized for U.S. Federal environment access
- **Production Admin** — Duo Security's Commercial, Dev, & FedRAMP Moderate
- **Federal OnCall Certified** — Cisco's Duo Security

EDUCATION

- **Full Stack Development Technical Certification** — Coding Dojo, Bellevue, WA
- **Technical Certification** — University of Washington, Seattle, WA